

Kookaburra

Searchable transcript

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Source: `Kookaburra -- Claire Saxby, Tannya Harricks.pdf` (32 PDF pages; story on PDF pages 6-27, index 29-30)

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> Internal school working copy prepared from a school-accessible PDF. Keep with the restricted book files. Do not publish this transcript in GitHub, Supabase, or the public progress viewer.

In the crinkled shadows, night dwellers yawn, day creatures stretch, and Kookaburra laughs. In a line on a limb with her mate and three young, she leads a sunrise chorus.

When they are done, her family members leave, each on a solo search for food. Kookaburra stays. She tips her head to the side, watches, watches, straightens, watches.

Kookaburras have very good eyesight, and tipping their head to the side helps them spot their prey more easily.

Together they go nest hunting. She kookas, he kookas, soft murmurings for their ears only.

Kookaburras mostly partner for life but still court before each nesting season.

Kookaburra and her mate flit from tree to tree in search of the perfect hollow. She peeks; he peeks.

Not right. They return to a familiar tree hollow--last year's nest. It's perfect.

Each year, pairs look for a new nesting hollow, but 50 percent of the time, they use the nest from the previous year. "It's perfect."

Her mate appears, a skink in his beak. It is a gift for Kookaburra as they approach a new nesting season.

Kookaburra listens. It is not her family. It is the call of strangers. She must act.

Kookaburra families have established territories and defend their borders.

Across the river that separates them, the other family laughs again. It is a challenge.

Territorial displays become more frequent as nesting season approaches.

Kookaburra flies a high circle over the opposition territory. A kookaburra from beyond the river circles Kookaburra's territory.

Kookaburra's mate flies toward a tree, flares his feathers at the mouth of a hollow, then returns to sit alongside her. A neighbor mirrors his flight.

The birds are saying, "This is our place."

The songs dwindle. Their boundaries are safe for now. And it's lunchtime. Again, Kookaburra sits alone. There will be snails here.

She watches and swoops. Thwack, thwack -- she cracks a shell and swallows. She returns to the nesting hollow to check that it is ready for the eggs she will soon lay.

In preparation for laying eggs.

Her mate is nearby. He comes and goes, bringing a cricket, then a worm. She kookas. He kookas.

A single kookaburra appears. This is an invasion. Kookaburras family attacks, fast and fierce.

Sometimes kookaburras invade other territories.

As day drifts into evening, Kookaburra gathers her family. Soon she will lay her eggs. While she sits on them, Kookaburra's family will bring food, protect their territory, and sometimes share the nesting.

Kookaburras usually lay three eggs at a time. They are dull white and about the size of golf balls. Kookaburra families mostly roost close together.

Once the chicks are hatched, the family will share the tasks of feeding, teaching, and raising them. But not today. Today Kookaburra leads the night song. This twilight, in a line on a limb with her family, her mate, Kookaburra laughs. Kook-kook-kook. Kak-kak-kak.

Removed from the story flow during cleanup (book prose preserved word for word; page refs are PDF pages):

- Side panels: the prefixes "" and "" were our labels and have been stripped; the panel prose itself is kept. Bracketed single-character/word flags inside panels were unwrapped without guessing beyond the visible letters: "" → "a", "" → "eggs", "" → "kookaburras", "othe" → "other territories".
- PDF page 10 (nest approach): vision-verified 9 Sept 2026 -- "Her mate appears, a skink in his beak. It is a gift for Kookaburra as they approach a new nesting season." Now in the story flow above. Also verified on-page: "Not right. They return to a familiar tree hollow--last year's nest. It's perfect."
- Nesting-hollow panel: the line "It's perfect." stood as "" -- kept as book prose in quotes.
- PDF page 16: vision-verified 9 Sept 2026 -- closing gathering reads "In a line on a limb with her family, her mate, Kookaburra laughs. Kook-kook-kook. Kak-kak-kak." Now in the story flow above.
- "She kookas. He kookas." -- the text layer read "keokas"; the printed page (vision-verified 9 Sept 2026) reads "kookas".
- Evening-gathering line: vision-verified 9 Sept 2026 -- "gathers her family" (the layer read "nest").
- Page 28: distribution panel mentioning Australia and Western Australia garbled; illustrated index (pages 29-30) illegible in the text layer. Not included as story prose.
- The opening spreads show the family in a line on a limb leading the sunrise chorus then dispersing to solo food searches while Kookaburra stays watching (per prose cues; not pixel-verified).
- The middle spreads show the nest hunt (peeking hollows, "It's perfect"), the stranger-call alert, the river territory laughing duel, and the mirrored high-circle flights (per prose cues; not pixel-verified).
- The closing spreads show the snail lunch, courtship feeding of cricket and worm, the family attack on the invader, and the twilight night song in a line on a limb (per prose cues; not pixel-verified).

Story text transcribed from the embedded text layer (PDF pages 6-27), joined across line breaks, then fully checked against 150 dpi renders on 9 September 2026: the skink-gift passage, "Not right" hollow passage, "It is a challenge", "He kookas", "gathers her family" and the closing calls were corrected from the printed pages. Dedication and imprint/copyright matter (page 4), the title page (5), the distribution panel (28) and the illustrated index (pages

29-30) are not included as story prose.